

MSI P610

It's No Nano!

Here's an option for those who want something like the iPod nano, but don't want to spend as much. The MSI 1 GB P610 media player even looks similar to the nano.



The stylish P610 sports a sturdy steel metallic body, and weighs just 45 gms. The 1.8-inch TFT LCD is bright enough to view even in broad daylight, though the interface is not that great; it was sluggish during playback.

In addition to MP3 (with lyrics), WMA (also with DRM), and WAV playback, it also plays back MOV and AVI video—MPEG. A JPEG photo viewer, FM radio, voice / line-in recorder, and a text viewer completes the package.

There is support for SRS sound, WOW, and TruBass. The provided ear-phones do an excellent job in pumping bass into your ears, even though the

player itself does not produce noteworthy bass levels. Overall, the sound is good. There are two file transfer modes: Media Transfer Mode supported by Windows Media Player 10, and Media Class Storage, in which the player is recognised as a removable drive.

This player went on and on for around 15 hours. Priced at Rs.6,400, it looks good and performs well, but doesn't appeal as much: Apple offers double the space for just Rs 1,000 more!

Specifications

2 GB, 45 gms, 1.8-inch TFT LCD, USB MTP and MSC transfer mode, music formats: MP3, WMA, WAV; video formats: M-JPEG, photo format: JPEG, lyrics: TXT

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E-mail: marketing@msi-india.com
Web site: www.msi-india.com
Price: Rs 6,400

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Package contents	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

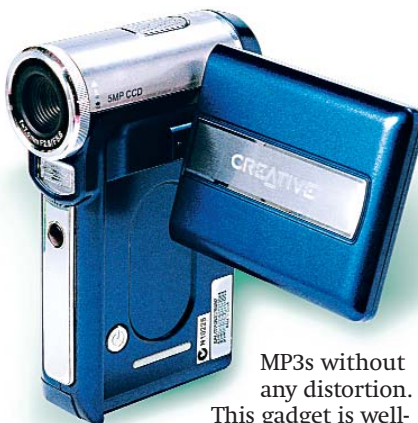
Creative DiViCAM 525D

A One-Stop Solution

Creative's DiViCAM 525D can moonlight as a video camera, a still camera, an MP3 player, a video player, a sound recorder, and even as a Web cam. All this in a package that fits perfectly in your palm. The screen neatly folds into the side, and turns on the camera when opened. This "multi-cam" has a 5 MP CCD. The 2.5-inch LCD screen is bright and has good colour reproduction. A proprietary motion stabiliser means jerk-free video.

With a Kingston 1 GB SD card in the bay, the Creative 525D promises 1 hr 27 minutes of video, or 415 photos at the highest resolution settings. Video quality is amazing, considering that this is an all-in-one solution, even under artificial light, and audio quality was equally good. A true camcorder will give you better results though.

Photo quality was average, both indoors and outdoors. The flash is powerful enough to give you clear shots in the dark. As a media player, it was brilliant, and played videos and



MP3s without any distortion.

This gadget is well-suited for users who want a single thing that can do it all. For those who are looking for a real handycam, we don't recommend this one—get an entry level camcorder from Sony or JVC instead.

Specifications

5 MP still photo, videos at 640 x 480 at 30 fps, 8x digital zoom, 2.5-inch LCD viewfinder, video format: AVI, audio formats: MP3 and WAV, 32 MB internal memory, SD card support, USB 2.0

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Contact: Compuage Infocore
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Web site: www.creative.com
Price: Rs 19,000

Gigabyte GA-965P-DQ6

965 "Heat-Pipe" Edition

Built around Intel's shiny new P965 chipset, the DQ965 is a Premium offering. Based on a sturdy and overclocker friendly 12 phase design, this motherboard nonetheless makes do with passive cooling via heat-pipes.

Gigabyte's always been bundle and feature friendly and with integrated 8 channel HD audio, and co-axial audio outs, and firewire to go with the eight



serial ATA ports and bounty of PCIe slots (1 x 16x, 1 x 4x, 1 x 1x).

The DQ965 is reasonably laid out, though a longer graphics card will interfere with memory removal. The CPU region is a bit cramped as well due to the heat pipe solution.

The BIOS is eminently tweakable, and you can [Ctrl] + [F1] to find bountiful memory, CPU, and even PCI-E (graphics) tweaks. Nearly all voltages can be adjusted. With a lead of 85 points in PC Mark 05 (over similar configurations), this board is fast!

We were able to boot at 350 MHz FSB (default: 266), with our Core 2 Duo Extreme stable at 3.15 GHz with no tweaking at all. We could have gone even higher, but decided to call it a very satisfactory day! A great looker, a great performer, but at rupees 16,800 it's pricey!

Specifications

Intel 965P chipset, Core 2 Duo ready, 1066 MHz FSB, 12-phase power design, supports up to 4 GB DDR2 800 MHz, PCI-E x16, PCI-E x4, 8 SATA ports

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

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Price: Rs 16,800